

Write to the Editor

E-mail: editor@thinkdigit.com

Snail Mail: The Editor, Digit, D-222/2, Om Sagar Building, MIDC, TTC Industrial Estate, Nerul Navi Mumbai 400 706

Digit will publish the best letters on these pages. Letters may be edited for clarity. Please include your complete address in all communication.

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Inbox

LETTER
OF THE
MONTH

Publish My Letters!

This is my third letter to Team Digit. Unfortunately, you haven't published either of the preceding two. Anyway, the purpose of my writing is to keep in touch with you...

The October issue was mind-blowing and really useful. The laptop section was helpful for everyone, especially for students. The way you categorised the laptops was indeed great. I really liked the Compaq Presario at a good price of Rs 50K, and the Dell Inspiron 6400. But I was disappointed that you missed out on Apple notebooks. Really, those MacBooks are cool—you should have reviewed them.

Could you suggest a laptop that supports SuSE Linux 10.1 under 70K?

Last month's issue was close to being the best *Digit* ever! Graphics cards, laptops, and other stuff were mind-blowing.

If only you could've shipped a Linux distro like SuSE 10.1 or Fedora Core. I'm looking forward to seeing a shootout between SuSE Linux 10.1 (Xgl), Windows Vista (the Aero interface) and Mac OS X Leopard (its 3D interface).

These OSes are very advanced—why don't you review them for us in the coming months? Anyway, keep up the good work, guys! You really are praiseworthy.

Tarun Brari

Dear Tarun,
Glad you liked the laptop test. Comparing the MacBooks on the same platform as the rest wouldn't have been fair to either. You can, however, find the MacBook and MacBook Pro reviewed in this issue.

If you plan on using SuSE Linux on your laptop, rest assured—SuSE has some pretty impressive hardware support, and should run fine on any of our test winners—just take your pick!

If you intend to use XGL, however, do make sure you choose one with a good graphics card.

Finally, the battle for the prettiest desktop may rage on as much as it chooses to, but if we do pit the three OSes against each other, we'll be looking at what lies underneath.

— Executive Editor

Worth Every Penny!

Your mag is awesome! I can't believe all the money that I've spent for your mag...and every time I bought it, it left me empty-pocketed, but delighted. I just want you guys to know that you have helped me win a lot of battles between man and machines. Thank you guys.

Moses Hnamte
Mizoram

Dear Moses,

We always knew that our mag gives a bang for every buck you spend, but to get that from a reader does motivate us further.

— Executive Editor

Sold Out!

Thanks to your magazine, it has really improved my knowledge on technology. I recently got selected from my school to represent it at the All Goa Computer Quiz on 12 November, 2006. When enquired about my knowledge source, I told them its *Digit*. Soon I saw a lot of students buying your magazine and within 4 days all bookstalls in the city had finished their stock of *Digit*!

Please review PDAs as soon as you can. Also, please try to include *Fast Tracks* to Internet, Gaming, Windows XP, Web Design, etc.

Aashish Kamath
Goa

Dear Ashish,
Congratulations on being selected for the computer quiz at Goa and wish you good luck for it. I am sure you're gonna win laurels for your school at this competition.

As for the *Fast Track* to the titles you have mentioned, well as I have said earlier in my reply to a reader, we've got a lot of letters from readers asking whether they can purchase past titles or can we send them our old stock by VPP—the answer to that is No. Sorry to say this, but we do not have past issues of *Fast Track* to sell or distribute free as of now. But yes, we promise to give all of them as a PDF in our December 2006 CD. So make sure you grab it in the 1st week of December. Your PDA review demand has been noted, we did review them in our June 2006 issue, and will revisit them soon.

— Executive Editor

Even More Ways To Stop Piracy

I have been a regular subscriber to *Digit* since its inception and enjoy reading the articles. Though my work domain is not directly IT-related, functionally I am required to be IT-savvy, and *Digit* is one of the resources to fulfil this requirement.

Recently, I have seen several letters to you with regard to software piracy in India, and the responses from *Digit*. While there are several strong arguments on both sides, especially how overseas software companies treat India with regard to the pricing of their products, I do agree that piracy is not the solution.

Therefore, in order to “educate” the general Indian public, *Digit* would do good work if you could frequently publish a list of free software that are equivalent to popular operating systems (Windows), office applications (MS Office), and multimedia software.

Further, *Digit* could consider occasionally bundling such freeware in an exclusive DVD or CD that are supplied with the magazine, or sell them separately if allowed by the freeware license. I am sure that with such a concerted effort, software piracy can be reduced substantially.

However, please understand that open source freeware such as Linux does not find favour for most “non-geek” users, who are averse to command-based software, and therefore would not serve much to accomplish the prime objective.

I hope *Digit* will find this suggestion suitable for adoption.

Ashok Sundar
Chennai

Dear Ashok,

We never miss an opportunity to remind readers that we're clairvoyant—this time's *Fast Track* to Open Source Software, and the pile of open source software on this time's DVD should give you all you need, and then some.

Please let go of the “open source is for geeks” attitude—it's true to some extent for Linux, but both the OS and the software have evolved into more user-friendly packages over the years, and will continue to do so in the future.

— Executive Editor